Steadyhand Grips

STEADYHAND GRIPS
Executive Summary

Problem

Millions of Americans live with arthritis, essential tremor, Parkinsons and other conditions that effect there hands. For these people everyday tasks like stirring a pot, using a peeler or pruning roses becomes painful and sometimes impossible. This loss of ability is not just a physical problem it is a emotional one as well, because cooking and gardening are things that give people a sense of purpose and independance. When they can no longer do them they often have to rely on family members or caregivers which impacts quality of life in a big way. We believe this is a significant problem that is not being addressed properly in todays market.

Solution

Steadyhand Grips is a custom solution that addresses this problem head on. We take a mold of each customers hand using a safe moldable material, and then we create a grip made to fit that exact hand which attaches to the persons existing utensils and tools. Because every hand is different, and every condition is different, our approach is personal and tailored rather than one size fits all. The grip is made from durable materials that is comfortable and easy to clean. Along with the grip we provide a fitting service, where one of our team members works with the customer to make sure the grip is right and adjust it if needed. This combination of a physical product and a personal service is what makes Steadyhand unique and gives customers a feeling of being cared for.

Market

The market for our product is very large. According to our research there are tens of millions of adults in the United States with some form of arthritis and many more with other hand conditions, and this number is growing every year as the population gets older. Baby boomers are retiring and want to stay active and independant for as long as possible. If even a small percentage of these people were to purchase our grips this would be a multi million dollar opportunity. We also believe there is potential in related markets such as occupational therapy, assisted living facilities, and eventually the general consumer market for ergonomic tools. The adaptive products space is expanding rapidly and we are positioned to take advantage of this trend.

Business Model

Our business model is based on selling custom grips along with the fitting service. Customers would pay for the fitting and the grip together, and we may also offer additional grips for other tools at a lower price. We are still determining our exact pricing but we are looking at somewhere between a fair price that customers can afford and a price that allows us to be profitable. In the future we may also explore subscription options, partnerships with therapists and clinics, and selling through retail channels. We think there are many different ways to generate revenue and we will figure out which is best as we grow and learn more about our customers needs. Our costs will include materials, molding supplies, labor for the fittings, and marketing.

Competition

There are existing companies that sell adaptive kitchen tools and ergonomic grips, and some of them have been around for a long time. However we believe that our product is different because it is truly custom and comes with a personal service. Most of the competition sells standard sized foam handles or thick utensils that dont fit everyone. Some people also make there own grips at home using tape or putty. We believe our customers will pay more for something that is made for them specifically. We also think that our team is more passionate and more agile then larger companies who may be slow to respond to customer feedback. Our personal approach is

something that is difficult for others to copy, although we know that competitors could try.

Team

Brianna Kowalczyk is our CEO and a junior studying business, she came up with the idea after watching her grandmother struggle in the kitchen because of arthritis. She leads strategy, sales and customer relationships. Dev Raghunathan is our CTO and is a senior studying mechanical engineering, he designed our prototype and handles the molding process and materials. Tyler Okonkwo-Banks is our head of operations and is a sophomore studying marketing, he manages our fittings, our social media and our website. Together we bring a mix of business, technical and creative skills and we are all very passionate about helping people. We have also spoken with a few advisors including a professor and a local occupational therapist who have given us helpful feedback, although they are not formally part of the company.

Milestones and Financials

So far we have achieved several important milestones. We have formed a C Corp, built a working prototype of our grip, launched a website, and most importantly we have our first paying client, who purchased a set of grips for her kitchen and gardening tools and said she was very happy with them. This proves that people are willing to pay for what we are offering. We have spent a small amount of our own money on materials and legal fees. Our financial projections show strong growth over the next three years, with revenue growing quickly as we reach more customers, and we expect to become profitable once we reach enough scale. We are confident that the numbers will work out because the demand is so large and our product provides so much value to customers.

What We Are Asking For

We are applying to this competition for funding that will help us take Steadyhand Grips to the next level. With the prize money we would purchase better molding equipment, hire part time help for the fittings, improve our website, and do more marketing to reach new customers. We are also looking for mentorship from experienced entrepreneurs and connections to potential partners such as clinics and senior living communities. Beyond the money, being part of this competition would give us credibility and visibility which are very important for a young company like ours. We believe that Steadyhand has the potential to change the lives of many people and we would be honored to have the chance to share our vision with the judges. Thank you for considering our application and we look forward to the opportunity to grow with your support.